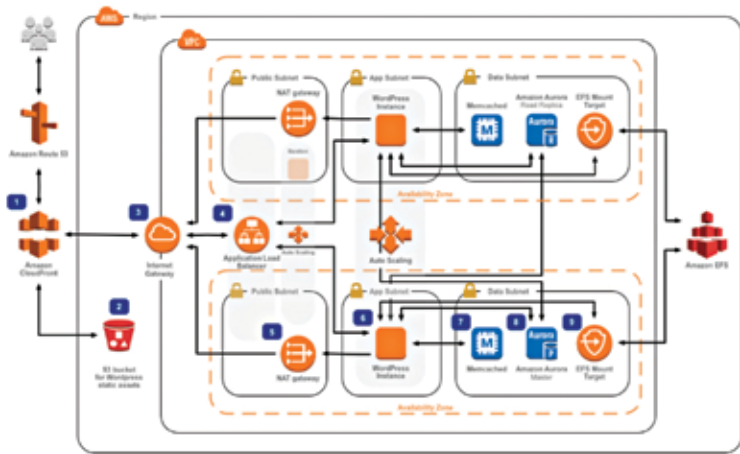




about each component that should help you think about web architecture in the future.

Domain Name System (DNS)

DNS (Domain Name System) is a backbone technology that allows the world wide web to function. DNS provides a key/value lookup from a domain name (e.g., google.com) to an IP address (e.g., 185.157.45.155) at the most basic level, which is required for your computer to route a request to the proper server.

The distinction between a domain name and an IP address is analogous to the difference between “call John Doe” and “call 9988776655.”

In the same way that you used to require a phone book to seek out John’s phone number, you now need DNS to look up a domain’s IP address. As a result, you can think of DNS as the internet’s phone book.

We could go into a lot more detail here, but we won’t because it’s not necessary for our basic introduction.

Load Balancer

A load balancer is a device that distributes the load evenly across the network. Before we get into the nitty-gritty of load balancing, let’s talk about horizontal vs. vertical application scalability. What exactly are they, and how do they differ?

Horizontal scaling, as explained in this StackOverflow post, is adding